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APPRECIATION

MIRROR- SYLVIA PLATH

Mirror is a confessional poem by Sylvia Plath, a famous American modern poet known for her confessional poems. This poem is a lyric that explores themes of truth, time, ageing, and identity. The poem is spoken in the voice of a mirror, which honestly reflects whatever it sees. Through the mirror, the poet shows how human beings find it difficult to accept the truth about themselves

In the beginning, the mirror describes itself as “silver and exact,” showing that it reflects everything truthfully without judgment. It has no feelings, like love or dislike, and is introduced as “The eye of a little god, four-cornered” which sees everything clearly and truthfully, like God who misses nothing, with the rectangular shape of the mirror. It judges no one but observes everything. Most of the time, it reflects a pink wall and feels connected to it. When people stand in front of the mirror or when darkness falls, their faces and the darkness repeatedly replace the wall reflected in the mirror.

In the second part of the poem, the mirror becomes a lake, suggesting depth. We can see a woman bends over it and searches for her true self. The mirror shows her real appearance, which makes her unhappy so She turns to candlelight and moonlight because they hide reality. Even though she turns away, the mirror faithfully reflects her as she is, People love false reflections that make them feel better, even if they are not their true self. Every morning, she sees herself growing old. The poem ends with the image of an old woman rising in the mirror, showing the loss of youth and the fear of ageing.

The poem is rich in poetic devices. Personification is used when the mirror speaks, as in “I have no preconceptions.” Metaphor is seen in “The Eye of a little god” and “Now I am a Lake.” Imagery is used in “It is pink, with speckles.” Simile appears in “like a terrible fish,” highlighting the fear of old age. Symbolism is evident as the mirror stands for truth, and “the candles or the moon” represent illusion. These devices add depth and meaning to the poem.

In conclusion, Mirror is a powerful poem that shows how people find it difficult to accept reality. Through simple language and strong images, Sylvia Plath presents the painful truth about ageing and self-identity. The poem prompts us to think deeply about truth and self-acceptance, making it memorable and meaningful.

LANGUAGE ELEMENTS

Complete the following passage choosing the correct word from those given in brackets.

1. (At, in, with, on and, to)

I thought it over and resolved -- go to her. I would invite to come back in here – write everything she wanted.She was sitting - the table,leaning --her elbows -- her head --her hands.

Answers (to,and,at, on, with, in)

2. (From, as if, and, without, to, the.)

She began – shift – foot to foot – moving from – place – spluttered comically – she wanted to say something and couldn't.

Answers :to from, without, the, and, as if.

Complete the following conversations between Teresa and the student

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1.Student:---------a------.?
Teresa: will you do one favour for me?
Student:Yes,--------b-------.
Teresa: I want to send a letter home.
Student : sit down and dictate,---------c-----?
Teresa : To my dear Boles my lover.
Student : Is he a young man?
Teresa: you had better not----------d----.

Answers
a. What do you want?
b. With pleasure
c. Will you?
d. Ask such silly questions

2.Teresa : you have no pressing business,-----a-----?
Student :No,-------b-------?
Teresa : I will be very thankful,--------c------.
Student:------d-----------?
Teresa: No,this time it is from him.
Student:OK.

Answers
, a. Have you?
b. What's
the matter?
c. If you write another letter for me.
d. Is it to Boles?

Read the following dialogue and complete the sentences given below.

1. Student :what do you want.?
Teresa :I want to beg a favour of you.
1.Student asked Teresa------
2Teresa replied that ----------.

Answers
1.what she wanted.
2.She wanted to beg a favour of him.

Teresa: why are you so surprised?. Cannot I a girl have a young man?
Student :yes. All things are possible.
1. Teresa asked ---------
2. Student answered ----------

Answers
1 Teresa asked student why he was so surprised she also asked if she a girl couldn't have a young man.
2 students answered positively that all things were possible..

DDE KOLLAM

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Pick out from the sentences noun phrase in the subject position, verb phrase and noun phrase in the object position.

1. The woman opposite me examined the piece of paper.
2. I want a European person.

Answers.
1 noun phrase in subject position "the woman opposite me.'
verb phrase 'examined '
Noun phrase in object position 'piece of paper.'

Pick out from the sentences verb phrase and prepositional phrase.
1. I was a student at Moscow.
2. She was thrown into prison.

Answers :
1. Verb phrase 'was a student,'
prepositional phrase' at Moscow '
2. Verb phrase' was thrown,'
prepositional phrase 'into prison'.

Fill in the blanks with the correct phrasal verbs from the brackets

(Put out, give in, call on, put across.)

Teresa __visited__ the student one morning she __communicated__ her demand to write a letter for her. But the student was -_annoyed_ when he knew that the letter was to a young man. But when she requested he had to _yield__.

Answers :(called on, put across, put out, gave in)

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